A-A-50091
January 9, 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SCALE SYSTEM, PREPACKAGED FOOD, AUTOMATIC

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to type I, style B, class 2 of MIL-S-43147D(GL).

1. Intended use. This commercial item description covers a scale system for automatically weighing, overwrapping, pricing, and printing and affixing labels to prepackaged food items.

2. Salient characteristics.

2.1 Design and construction. The scale system shall consist of an automatic wrapping machine, a digital computer scale, a thermal label printer with dispenser rack and the capacity for printing universal product code bar symbols, and a mobile rotary bin. The system shall have the capacity to automatically weigh, wrap, and affix item/pricing labels to various size packages. The packages shall range in different sizes up to 12 inches long by 10 inches wide by 5 inches high and shall be processed at the rate of 22 to 32 per minute. All operating control mechanisms for the system shall be conveniently located for the operator.

2.2 Wrapping machine. The automatic wrapping machine shall be rigidly constructed of steel or aluminum and readily accessible for cleaning. The unit shall have the capacity to automatically weigh the prepackaged item then feed, measure, overwrap, cut, and heat seal the plastic wrapping to the package. The unit shall be equipped with a weighing platter and incoming and outgoing conveyor belts. The unit shall have the capacity to accommodate three or more rolls of wrapping film of various widths up to 18 inches wide. The unit shall have a mechanism to stretch wrap the film completely around the package and shall be equipped with a mechanical film cutter and thermostatically controlled heat sealer. The incoming powered conveyor belt shall feed packages onto the platter for weighing. This processing step shall require no pusher arm contact with package until weighing has been completed. The outgoing conveyor belt shall feed the weighed, wrapped, and labeled package into the rotary bin.

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2.3 Scale and thermal label printer. The digital computing scale shall be connected to both the wrapping machine and label printer. The scale shall consist of: a modular component scale with counter type platform, a solid state controlling mechanism with electronic memory, and a printer with universal bar code printing capability. The scale and printer shall be designed for use in rooms with 10% to 95% relative humidity. The controlling mechanism shall incorporate a back-up battery for memory retention up to 20 hours in the event of an external power failure. The scale and printer shall operate as a system to automatically weigh, compute, print and issue labels, and collect total data for management use. The scale shall provide for a digital readout of unit price, total weight in pounds, and total price in dollars. The scale shall be electronically programmable with a minimum memory capability of 700 commodity descriptions with price lookups and 40 user-programmable grade descriptions. The size of the platform shall be essentially the same as the scale base. The scale shall weigh in increments from zero to 30 pounds. Prices per pound shall range from $0.01 through $99.99. Maximum computed cost per package shall be $999.99. Light emitting diodes shall display a minimum of five digits. The printer shall automatically deliver and affix printed, heat sealed or pressure-sensitive labels displaying the date, with minimum of 26 characters of description, total weight, unit price, total dollars, and universal product code bar code symbols. Minimum label capacity shall be 5,000 labels per roll. Provisions shall be made for tare weight. Maximum dimensions of the scale shall not exceed 20 inches in width, 20 inches in depth, and 19 inches in height. Maximum dimensions of the printer shall not exceed 19 inches in width, 16 inches in depth, and 16 inches in height.

2.4 Mobile rotary bin. The mobile bin shall be constructed of aluminum or steel or a combination of both metals. The minimum diameter of the bin shall be 27 inches and minimum depth shall be 9 inches. The rotary bin shall be equipped with casters and shall have an adjustable height lever to raise the bin 29 to 37 inches above the floor level.

2.5 Electrical. The wrapping machine shall operate on 208 volts, 60 hertz, 1 phase and the components of scale system shall operate on 120 volts, 60 hertz, 1 phase power source. When specified (see 5.1), the wrapping machine and the components of the scale system shall operate on 220 volts, 50 hertz, 1 phase power source.

3. Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of the description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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4. Packaging. The scale system shall be packaged, packed, and marked in accordance with the domestic or overseas requirements of ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5. NOTES

5.1 Ordering data.

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When ordering, specify left to right or right to left operational scale system.
c. Specify electrical requirements (see 2.5).

5.2 Source for nongovernment association documents.

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodian

Army - GL

Review Activity

Army - TS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FCGC

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

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